CORY BLAKE CROOK

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Cyber Defense Engineer/Analyst

- ✓ Advanced cybersecurity professional with 6+ years' experience in infosec infrastructure design, Technology migration, security tool implementations, process roll-out and software maintenance versioning control.
- ✓ Skilled analyst/Engineer with adaptive process efficiency. Extensible idealist with prompt and efficient ability to navigate security alert resolution processes. Ensuring swift remediation through creation and enforcement of strong security policies and controls resulting in secure business operations and limited threat exposure.

EDUCATION & HONORS

Bachelor of Applied Science, Information Assurance & Cybersecurity – Western Governors University, **2021**

- Managing Infosec & Emerging Tech in Cybersecurity Excellence Awards. **Honors Society** (**2020 & 2021**)

Cyberstart Essentials Track, Certificate of Distinction – SANS Institute, (**2019 & 2020)**

Associate Degree, Information Technology Specialist – University of Alaska, Fairbanks, **2018**

- 4.0 GPA – Summa Cum Laude; Chancellor's list 6/6 Semesters
- CTC Student of the Year x 2 (**2017 & 2018**)

SANS Undergraduate Certificate Cybersecurity - Full Ride Scholarship, **2023**

- GIAC Advisory Board Admittance (**2022**)
- 4.0 GPA – Summa Cum Laude; Dean's list

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Certifications	ISC2 Associate, SSCP, GIAC: GFACT, GSEC, GCIH, GSOC, Security+, CompTIA Project+, CompTIA A+, CompTIA Network+, IT Operation Specialist, Certified Internet Webmaster, Secure Infrastructure Specialist, Autopsy Training, CISA ICS Cybersecurity **Certs in progress:** MS: AZ-500, SC-900, PnPT, Python Micro Degree, DevOps Engineer
Operating Systems	Windows, Windows Server, Linux, Unix, IOS, Android, Raspbian, Remnux, SIFT, Kali
Programming	Python, PowerShell, Sigma, Md.a Basic skills: HTML, PHP, Git, C++, Java, Bash, Ruby
Applications	O365 Security, Azure AD & MS Defender, Pentesting tools, Autopsy, Cyware, R7, Volatility, OSINT Tools, MS Sysinternals, Yara, Splunk, Carbon Black, Crowdstrike, ServiceNow, Digital Guardian, Sophos, Burpsuite, Cisco, Mitre Att&ck, Metasploit
DB's/SIEM	MySQL, SQLLite, & OSSEC / Splunk, Elastic, Devo, Qradar, Azure Sentinel, Kibana
Firewalls/GRC	Palo Alto, FortiGate, Check Point, Ubiquity / SOX, HIPPA, GLBA, PCI, NIST, FIPS, CIS

TECHNICAL QUALIFICATIONS

SIEM/SOAR Engineer – TE Connectivity 2022–Present

Developed a Detection-as-Code pipeline process to support cybersecurity inputs for Threat intel, Threat Hunting, Red Team, GRC, Vulnerability Management, and Incident Response. A pipeline to streamline cyber readiness and deployment from the inputs to outputs which fortified defensive strength within the organization.

- Engineered Detections based on risk scoring / risk assessment and managed the Detection engineering team.
- Create Playbooks and SOPs based on detection logic and triage processes leveraging I/O of a SOC.
- Designed Security Controls and Monitoring techniques for 89,000 users and 150,000+ assets in 140 Countries.
- Managed the SIEM engineering by configuring parsers, aggregators, loggers, log sources and collectors.
- Implemented SOAR workflows with inputs from the detection pipeline and through micro-automation.

Cybersecurity Analyst – CGI 2020–2022

Detected, Analyzed, and responded to active and potential threats in a highly secure environment. Mitigated future attacks by aligning business processes with security policies and industry cybersecurity frameworks, CIS and FIPS.

- Investigated incidents to uncover potential IoC's, remediated and then reported to Mgmt. and Stakeholders.
- Managed 1000+ assets in over 12+ locations for over 5000+ employees within highly secure environments.
- Handled security alerts using SIEM and next-gen firewall IDS/IPS to detect/prevent data loss or breach.
- Investigated Phishing reports, DLP detections, monitored and reported sensitive/controlled data mishandling.

Security Architect/Engineer – Empathy Link 2019–2023

Spearheaded security engineering and architecture — a top-to-bottom software and hardware installation project. Pioneered creation of detailed policies and procedures including research & recommendations, topology diagrams, Compliance and governance, Disaster Recovery and prevention plans, maintenance checklists, threat/ risk assessment analysis, and agile project management process.

- Conducted cost analysis for network security hardware and software, allowing for US$47,000 annual savings.
- Introduced change management solutions to address troubleshooting documentation and tech support escalation procedures within the network, resulting in a 37% weekly Return on investment.
- Successfully achieved a complex network remodeling and redesign that demonstrated Defense-in-Depth.
- Establishes secure network connections using VPN, proxies, VLAN segregation, and active firewall rules.
- Automated SOC processes using PowerShell and Python to enrich data sources and threat intelligence.

SMB Network Admin/College Student – Home Network Lab/ College Student Projects 2016–2022

Administered networks of 150+ user accounts and 200+ computer systems, providing network and local level support for various apps and databases. Formed Mach up of an assumed breach to simulate purple teams' exercise.

- Decreased alert fatigue 68% upon implementing Security Orchestration Automation Response (SOAR).
- Formulated security policies for, disaster recovery, automated patch management, online backups, enterprise antivirus, EDR threat mitigation and secure remote access solutions.
- Deployed, managed, monitored, and ingested logging for cloud infrastructure on Azure, AWS, and GCP.

Carpenter – CONSTRUCTION 2010–2015

Worked Different roles and assisted in the construction of multi-million-dollar projects. Saved multiple thousands of dollars throughout many long sprint projects across the Western United States. Projects totaling $100+ Million.

Technical Support Analyst – SPRINT TELECOMMUNICATIONS 2008–2010

Troubleshoot technical support tickets at a rapid pace excelling the most resolved trouble tickets within the shortest amount of time. Naturally adapted to governance and controls, inherent risk, and security operations software.

- Provided Level 2 hardware and software support to 5 million+ end users via phone, email, remotely and onsite.
- Monitored critical systems and mitigated threats based on playbooks formed from baseline configurations.
- Reported security related systems and events to all levels of Mgmt. on a regular basis (Executive, HR, Legal).

SKILLS SUMMARY

Cybersecurity Engineering | Network Security Monitoring | User Training & Support | Security Automation | SIEM | Team Leadership | Database Engineering | Detection Engineering | Cloud Computing | ITIL | Risk Management | Incident Response & Disaster Recovery | Software Development | IT Project Management | Network Segmentation | Offensive Security Engineering | Forensic Process & Analysis | Data Handling | Governance and Compliance | Computer Science | Reconnaissance | Passive and Active Scanning | Firewall Rules | Risk Assessment | Project Management | Cost Management | SOAR | Technical Communication | Reporting | Vulnerability Management | Post-Exploitation | Exploitation | Defense-in-Depth | Reconnaissance | Large-Scale Security Incident Triage |

PROJECTS

Detection-As-Code Pipeline Implementation

- Developed a Pipeline to prioritize detection pseudocode, engineer detection logic, create SOAR workflows, create playbooks, and push high fidelity peer reviewed detections into production to action incident response.
- Engineered detection logic to leverage enrichments and intelligence from other cyber tools and teams I/O.

Project Manager/Security Consultant/Chief Information Security Officer – Empathy Link Startup

- Validated security controls including Process Mapping, Risk & Control Matrices, Inherent Risk Assessments.
- Delegated tasks and assigned roles and responsibilities based on priority risk ratings.
- Designed and Implemented top to bottom IT and Security infrastructure with cloud driven scalability.
- Introduced a seamless integration with Security Onion, Kibana, Rsyslog, OSSEC, EDR, MFA, & Encryption.

Consortium and Skills Outreach Website- https://Heckintechin.tech

- Developing a community consortium blog/tutorial website for useful life hacks and all things tech.
- Displaying skillsets from over 40 CTF's I participate in annually across many information securities disciplines.